



The Global Offensive Badge

How it happened?

Valve has been really clever with the announcement of CS2. It started with the changing of banners before the launch of the Limited Test Beta back in March. At the time, they changed their Twitter banner in the buildup to the release, teased players by updating their depot files and adding a new branch called "today", right before the big announcement was made.

With CS2's release, the Seattle-based game giant seems to have taken a similar route. They started with an update to their Twitter banner and then added and quickly deleted a branch labelled as "today", before dropping the big update.

To announce the full release of the game, Valve put out a video on their Twitter handle, @CounterStrike.

What does the future hold for Counter-Strike 2?

Apart from doses of criticism from a few, the Counter-Strike 2 Limited Test was appreciated by many. A lot of players who have been around for years drew parallels to the CS:GO Beta when it was released over a decade ago. The next Counter-Strike Major is confirmed to be played on CS2 in Copenhagen between March 17 and 31, 2023. The player numbers are at an all-time high, and the community, much to the surprise of many, is receiving the game well. What more can you ask for a game this old? It is older than I am!

The only thing that I see going wrong for CS2 during its initial release days is the community being split, with one faction calling for the return of Global Offensive and the other sensibly moving to Counter-Strike 2. With time, this divide will also end, and everyone will be playing CS2. *



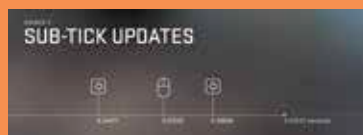
CS RATING

Counter-Strike 2 comes with a new seasonal rating system. It has a seasonal cycle, with the ratings being decided based on the outcome of matches played in the Premier game mode.



RESPONSIVE SMOKES

In Counter-Strike 2, smoke grenades react with the surroundings, filling in the space where they have been deployed in. In the words of Valve, they are now "dynamic volumetric objects", which can also interact with lighting, gunfire, and explosions.



SUB-TICK RATE

With CS2, Valve has ditched 64 and 128 Tick systems and introduced a new sub-tick system. Touted to be better than the older implementation of tick-rates, with sub-tick, the game registers the exact time stamp of an action and relays it to the server, instead of attributing an action to a tick.



NEW MAPS

The Source 2 upgrade gave Valve a chance to upgrade maps, equipping them with better aesthetics than ever before. They divided the maps into three categories - Full Overhaul Maps, Upgrade Maps, and Touchstone Maps, with each having their own levels of changes.



MAP BASED RANKS

Instead of having global ranks in competitive mode, Valve has now introduced map based ranks. The intention is to help players build a map pool for themselves before delving into Premier mode. Now, you can be a Silver 1 on Vertigo but a Global Elite on Dust II.



XP-DROPS

When you earn enough XP in a week to rank up, instead of a pre-defined two item drop, you will now get an option to choose two drops out of four that will be sent your way.